
Solution to Exercises

Exercise 1: 9 Nxe5 is just a bad move. After 9...Nxe4! 10 Nxe4 Bxe5 Black has the better game after both 11 Bg5 Rd4! and 11 O-O Nc6. His forces are more effectively placed and the d4-square makes a nice home for any number of black pieces.

Exercise 2: He would have been mated after 26...Rxh2+! 27 Bxh2 Qh7. The sacrifice doesn't work after 26 Bxg4 as White can interpose a piece on h3 or h5.

Exercise 3: 18...Qh4!! – a wonderful move which vacates the h5-square for the black knight. If White now plays 19 Nxc7 then after 19...Nh5 he gets checkmated. Black is threatening ...Ng3 mate. Here are White's attempts to stop it:

1) 20 Bf2 Qxh2+!! 21 Kxh2 Ng3+ 22 Kg1 Rh1 mate.

2) 20 h3 Ng3+ 21 Kh2 Bxh3!.

3) 20 g3 Nxg3+ 21 Kg2 Bh3+ 22 Kf2 Nh1 double checkmate (still just 1 point).

The only chance for White after 18...Qh4!! is to play the sad 19 g3 to prevent ...Nh5. After 19...fxg3 20 Nxc7 (20 Ng2 Qh3!) 20...Ng6! Black still has a decisive attack, although the variations are quite complicated. I'll just show one: 21 Nxa8? Qxh2+! 22 Bxh2 Rxh2+ 23 Kg1 Nf4 24 Rf2 Nh3+ 25 Kf1 Rxf2 mate.

Exercise 4: 18 Rxd6! wins a crucial pawn as 18...Qxd6?? 19 c5+ costs Black his queen.

Exercise 5: 11 Bxh6, which is not that bad a move, is met by 11...Nxe4! 12 fxe4 Qh4+ 13 g3 Qxh6 14 Qxh6 Bxh6 15 Nxd6 Rd8 when Black has good compensation for the pawn. This is an important tactic in many lines of the King's Indian. Often it will be more devastating than in this example.

Exercise 6: After 13 Bxh6? Nxe4! 14 fxe4 Qh4+ Black regains the piece with advantage.

Exercise 7: 15...Nxe4! 16 Nxe4? (16 b4 limits the damage; Black replies 16...Nxc3) 16...Qxe1! 17 Qxe1 Nf3+ 18 Kh1 Nxe1 19 Rxe1 Rxe4 and Black emerges with a decisive material advantage.

Starting Out: The King's Indian

Exercise 8: 10...Nfxe4! 11 Nxe4 Bf5 and now 12 Nfd2 fails to 12...Nxe4 13 Nxe4 Qh4+ and after 12 Bd3 Bxe4 13 Bxe4 f5 Black regains the piece with an active game (14 Bd3 e4).

Exercise 9: 11 b4? falls into Black's trap. After 11...Ncxe4! 12 Nxe4 Nxe4 13 Qxe4 Bf5 14 Qf3 e4 Black wins the rook on a1.

Exercise 10: Were you looking for a brilliant combination? Then you were wasting your time. The answer is 24...Nb8! and Black's one passive piece is brought back into play. After ...Nd7-f6 White's position is beginning to look decidedly shaky.

Exercise 11: It loses a pawn to 13 Nxc5! hxc5 14 Bxc5. Normally Black could meet 13 Nxc5 with 13...Nxc3 but he can't here as White is also threatening Qh7 mate.



starting out: the king's indian

Ideal for those wanting to understand the basics of the King's Indian.

The King's Indian is one of the most exciting defences in chess and is favoured by ambitious and aggressive players. At the highest level it has been a major weapon for World Champions Bobby Fischer and Garry Kasparov. In this easy-to-read guide, Grandmaster Joe Gallagher goes back to the basics of the King's Indian, studying the key principles of its many variations. Throughout the book there are numerous notes, tips, warnings and exercises to help the improving player, while important strategies, ideas and tactics for both sides are clearly illustrated.

- User-friendly design to help readers absorb ideas
- Concentrates on the key principles of the King's Indian
- Ideal for the improving player

Joe Gallagher is an English Grandmaster who has been living in Switzerland for a number of years and is a regular member of the Swiss national team. His many books have deservedly earned him a reputation as a first class writer. His previous works include *The Magic of Mikhail Tal* and *The Trompowsky*.



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